

Funding application to the University Association Erlangen-Nuremberg e. V.	
Date of application	October 26, 2025

Applicant	Prof. Dr. Cornelia Weise
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Chair/Professorship	Department of Psychology, Utah State University
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participating scientists/ inside	M.Sc. Christina Nuhn
Chair/Professorship	Clinical Psychology and Psychotherapy Working Group at Philipps-University of Marburg
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Subject of the application (see information sheet for applications)	As a newly appointed professor, Prof. Dr. Cornelia Weise Currently, FAU lacks sufficient resources to implement the training program for promoting transcultural competence, including a corresponding competency assessment. The project also enables a qualitative improvement in teaching by allowing students to practice, test, and continuously improve their acquired transcultural competencies using the developed assessment instrument (CCPT). The CCPT is intended to long-term use in teaching in the psychology degree program, but also for interdisciplinary training programs on transcultural competence at FAU. The requested funds will be used for the development and testing of the measuring instrument, as well as the development of an automated evaluation system, thereby enabling broad applicability. The funding will support key work steps in the...
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	The development of the instrument enables projects that could not be realized without this initial funding. The project thus meets the funding criteria of the university. federal, as it enables a newly appointed professor to establish a new research area, improves the quality of teaching, and allows for high scientific attention to be achieved with comparatively little funding.
Project/scientific framework (possibly attach as an enclosure)	See Annex 1.
time frame	01.11.2025-31.01.2027
Overall financing	The financing of the research staff, the costs for the training of the staff, as well as the costs for the implementation or maintenance of the training to promote transcultural competences (e.g. website costs, e-book licenses, training, assistants) are covered by residual funds from Prof. Weise at his previous university.
Have applications been submitted to other funding institutions?	No
Application amount (Please attach the cost estimate as an attachment)	€8,961.79 see Annex 2
Planned payout date for retrieval of the Approval (value per quarter) (e.g., Q3 2027)	Q1 2026: €3,876.35 (LIWC license, Unipark license, 5 months HiWi) Q2 2026: €1,907.04 (3 months HiWi) Q3 2026: €3,178.40 (4 months student assistant, student assistant hours, expert rating)

Appendix

1: Cultural competence made visible! Validation of a measurement instrument for the objective assessment of transcultural competence. Prof. Dr. Cornelia

Weise | Chair of Clinical Psychology and Behavioral Health Technology

1. Scientific background and objectives

Numerous studies show that transcultural competence is an important success factor for the success of interactions between people from different cultures, for example in the context of psychotherapy (Soto et al., 2018; Tao et al., 2015; Wampold & Owen, 2021).

Transcultural competence refers to the ability to work effectively with people from different cultural backgrounds. Given the increasing diversity of our society, the targeted promotion of transcultural competence in various interaction contexts is crucial. These include, on the one hand, psychotherapy and psychological counseling, and on the other hand, for example, university teaching, teacher training, or medical counseling settings.

In a separate study, we developed a training program specifically for psychotherapists to promote A transcultural competence training program (CulTher-Training) was developed and evaluated in a randomized controlled trial with 335 clinical psychologists (Studer et al., 2024, submitted). The results show that the training led to a significant improvement in knowledge and participants reported a higher level of competence (Nuhn et al., in press). However, it must be added that competence was assessed solely through questionnaires and thus based on self-report, as methods for objectively measuring transcultural competence are currently lacking. Self-report methods are susceptible to biases due to social desirability and overconfidence and therefore do not adequately reflect actual competence (Caron et al., 2020; Wilcox et al., 2020). An alternative is application-oriented testing, i.e., examinations with simulated participants, which are more realistic and objective. However, these tests are too personnel- and financially expensive for widespread use. In addition to the actual administration of the test, test scenarios must be developed beforehand, and examiners and simulation participants must undergo extensive training. A recent study (Nelles et al., 2024) showed that a total of 85 person-days are required for an application-oriented test for 39 individuals. Therefore, measurement instruments are needed that can assess cultural competence more objectively while also being resource-efficient for use with a large number of individuals.

The aim of the planned project is therefore to validate a standardized, objective, and practical measurement instrument for assessing transcultural competence. This instrument will be used, firstly, to evaluate the effectiveness of relevant training programs (e.g., by measuring competence acquisition in a pre-post comparison). Secondly, it will also serve as a learning tool itself, allowing training participants to continuously monitor their competence development and adjust their training participation (e.g., the number or type of exercises performed).

If the developed measurement instrument proves to be reliable and valid, it will be used in the future in university teaching, both in the Master's degree programs in Psychology (in which the acquisition of competence is a central component) and in the implementation and evaluation of cross-faculty trainings to promote transcultural competence at FAU.

2. Study design

As part of a preliminary study, the *Cultural Competence Performance Task* (CCPT), an instrument for the objective assessment of transcultural competence, was developed and piloted on a small sample. Based on participant feedback, the instrument was further refined. It will be revised and improved. The planned study will examine the CCPT for reliability and construct validity using a sufficiently large sample.

The CCPT will be used in the randomized controlled CulTher2.0 study, which starts in November 2025. This study will investigate a revised and improved version of the CulTher training program for promoting transcultural competence. The training places particular emphasis on the practical application of transcultural competence and the ease of applying the learned strategies in professional practice. The CCPT will serve as an objective measurement instrument in this study and will be used in addition to self-report measures to assess the effectiveness of the training. A total of 171 participants are expected to be enrolled in the study, including master's students from [University Name]. Clinical psychology and psychotherapy, psychotherapists in training or further education, and licensed psychotherapists.

The CCPT is designed in such a way that it can be adapted in the future for different professional groups and educational areas in which transcultural competence is relevant.

3. The Cultural Competence Performance Task (CCPT): Structure, procedure and evaluation

The measuring instrument is based in its structure on the established "Facilitative interpersonal" The skills (FIS) exercise (Anderson et al., 2009) involves participants watching short video clips in which simulated individuals portray challenging situations in transcultural psychotherapy and counseling. Each situation relates to one of five competency areas. (See Table 1 for examples of the competence areas and example situations). The study participants take on the role of therapists or counselors and respond to each video sequence as they would in a real-life interaction. During the task briefing, they are instructed on what to pay attention to in their response, e.g., "Encourage the patients to explain their statement in more detail." These responses are recorded as an audio file. and subsequently transcribed for statistical analysis. The process is illustrated in Figure 1.

Table 1: Overview of the five competence areas with example situations and specific competences

Competency area: Example situations		Specific skills
Subjective illness and healing concepts inquire	SP is skeptical: <i>"What can this psychotherapy even achieve? I need someone to free me from these panic attacks."</i> SP is avoidant/withdrawn: <i>"I absolutely cannot discuss</i>	PP explores subjective assumptions about illness and attributions of causes (e.g., magic, punishment), validates perspectives, and flexibly adapts its own reactions.
Dealing with Do not know	<i>my mental health problems with my family. They wouldn't understand. That would be a no-go!"</i>	PP is open to the question, reveals his own gaps in knowledge, and asks questions to better understand statements (e.g., What does SP mean by that?).
Ambiguity tolerance	SP appears agitated and says, <i>"I believe we are all surrounded by angels and if we take the positive action, then our mental health problems will go away on their own."</i>	PP validates that the topic is of great importance to the patient, shows openness to the mentioned viewpoints, and explores them without judging them as right or wrong.
Consideration of cultural factors	SP appears hopeless: <i>"I'm afraid that people won't understand me or that they will reject me." laugh at me. I constantly make mistakes in the language even though I've lived here for so long. I feel like a failure.</i>	PP proposes an alternative perspective, inquiring whether cultural or contextual factors (e.g., migration, language, discrimination) influence the complaints.
Inclusion of the Family system	SP expresses despair, saying, <i>"It is my duty to stay awake as long as possible to look after my husband and sons-in-law when they gather at our house. That's what a good wife does, even if it means I get too little sleep."</i>	PP explores complaints in the family context, jointly seeks solutions to difficulties without Giving advice flexibly switches between individual, group, and universal perspectives.

Note: SP = simulation person, PP = person being tested, Pat = patient

The suitability or adequacy of the therapeutic responses is determined based on the predefined criteria. Competencies are evaluated. Typical appropriate and inappropriate responses are specified for each competency area (see Table 1). In the original FIS exercise, participants' responses are subsequently evaluated by trained raters based on the competency areas. The innovative approach of our project lies in developing an automated evaluation process. The transcribed responses are then automatically analyzed using machine learning algorithms (in cooperation with the *Machine Learning and Data Analytics Lab*, FAU). Quantitative text analysis is used for the automated analysis, employing both the software *Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count* (LIWC) and *Large Language Models* (LLMs). To validate the automated analyses, additional trained raters are used to assess the participants' responses. These ratings will serve as a benchmark (gold standard). Automating the evaluation process aims to enable broader applicability of the test.



Fig. 1: Exemplary study procedure

4. Benefits for teaching, training and evaluation

In many professions (e.g. medicine, nursing, disaster relief) practical skills are used. Practical skills are practiced and tested through standardized simulations. These exercises contribute significantly to quality assurance and safety, and give learners the opportunity to apply their theoretical knowledge early on. The practical experience and targeted feedback enhance their professional competence and orientation.

The developed video-based measuring instrument CCPT expands the existing testing format and offers crucial advantages:

- **High standardization:** All participants edit the same videos, so that Performance differences can be objectively recorded.
- **Resource-efficient:** No additional examiners or simulation subjects required, lower costs and organizational effort.
- **Flexible application:** Digital, asynchronous and location-independent, suitable for both teaching and Continuing education and training.
- **Automated evaluation:** Thanks to automated analysis, this test format can be used for training and testing purposes with a large number of participants.

The CCPT thus offers a practical and efficient way to promote transcultural competences in teaching and further education across different disciplines.

5. Significance for FAU and long-term implications

The project makes an innovative contribution to competency-based learning in university-level psychology education at FAU. Furthermore, the CulTher training can be transferred to other disciplines such as medicine, education, or social sciences, or to existing counseling services like student counseling, in order to promote culturally sensitive skills. Here, the developed CCPT instrument (after successful validation in the current study) can be used as a training and evaluation tool, thereby sustainably improving both the quality of such training and university education in general.

In summary, the project has high potential to advance the development and evaluation of curricular and extracurricular measures to promote transcultural competence and to expand FAU's diversity and quality management with an innovative approach.

6. Scientific Director of the Study: Prof.

Dr. Cornelia Weise, Chair of Clinical Psychology and Behavioral Health Technology, Friedrich-Alexander University Erlangen-Nuremberg.

Cooperation Partners: Prof. Dr. Maria Kleinstäuber, Utah University, USA; **M.Sc. Christina Nuhn**, Philipps University Marburg; **Dr. Robert Richer**, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg

7. Bibliography

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Annex 2: Requested funds

The following funds are requested for the implementation of the project:

Cost item	Description of	Cost
Software license LIWC-22 (1-year license)	software for quantitative text analysis of therapeutic responses within the framework of validation of the measuring instrument.	€57.95
Access to Audio recordings (Unipark)	Technical implementation of data access to the stored audio files for evaluation and analysis of the reactions; see attached cost estimate: 4 hours at €160 per hour	€640.00
2 Student Support staff with BSc Degree (Psychology and Data Science)	Support with the technical implementation of the CCPT, transcription of audio recordings, technical support for participants, support with automated evaluation using LIWC, support with the development and technical implementation of the LLM evaluation, 2 people at 8 hours/week for 6 months each (at EUR 635.68) in the period between 01.12.2025 - 30.11.2026 (Auxiliary worker rate FAU: $635.68 \times 6 \times 2 = 7628.16\text{€}$)	€7,628.16
Assistant hours (BSc- Graduation) for Expert ratings of Audio recordings	Manual coding of therapeutic responses as the gold standard by 4 trained raters: (Audio recordings of 171 participants; parallel rating for $\frac{1}{4}$ of the recordings to check inter-rater agreement, total 36 hours) (Auxiliary worker rate FAU 36 hrs: €635.68)	€635.68
Total amount of funds requested:		€8,961.79



Quote

Prepared Date 24-Oct-2025
Quote# 69786

Quote Expires 23-Nov-2025
Billing Schedule 100% Upon Signature
Payment Terms Net 30
Term Start Date 1-Dec-2025
Term End Date 30-Nov-2026

Service Provider

Tivian XI Gmbh
Ottostraße 21
c/o Pinsent Masons
Munich 80333
Germany

Customer

Philipps-Universität Marburg

End User

Philipps-Universität Marburg

Bill To

Philipps-Universität Marburg
Gutenbergstraße 18
Marburg 35032
Germany

Ship To

Philipps-Universität Marburg
Gutenbergstraße 18
Marburg 35032
Germany

Bereitstellung von Audio-Dateien wie besprochen mit Herrn Voigt

Item	Qty	Item Description
Tiv-PS-Fix	1	Tivian Professional Fee
Total Fees Due		€640.00

For Customer: CUSTOMER SIGNATURE	For Service Provider: <i>Arthur Michel</i> Arthur Michel SERVICE PROVIDER SIGNATURE
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☐ NO. PO IS NOT REQUIRED

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Is the bill to address above correct or not?

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